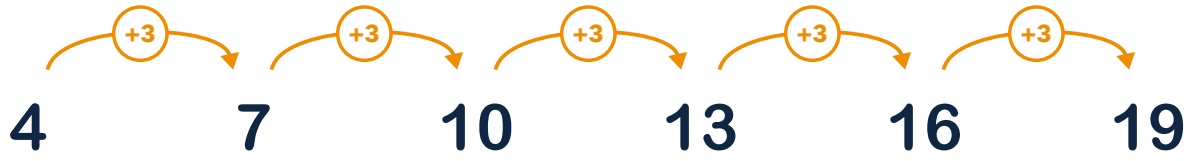
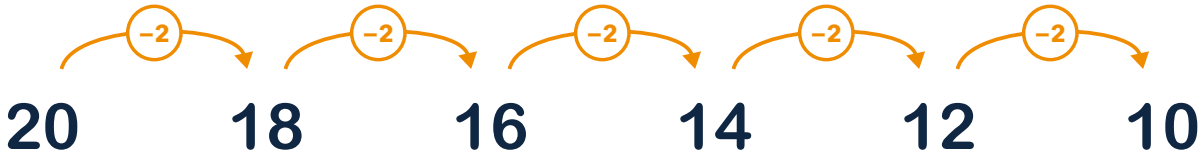
Counting Forward and Backward

Count by any number, from any number, either way.

Count forward by 3s



Count backward by 2s



Count by 25s, like quarters: 25 cents each



Your turn!



For teachers

Goal: count from any number, by any number, forward and backward, in your head. Say it out loud while pointing at each jump. Counting by 3s, 4s and 25s gets kids ready for multiplication and money.

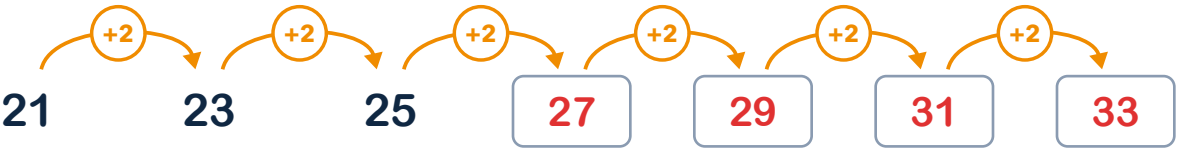
Counting Forward and Backward: Practice

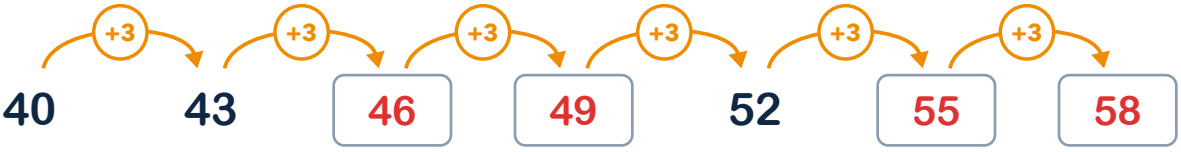
Jump by the same amount each time.

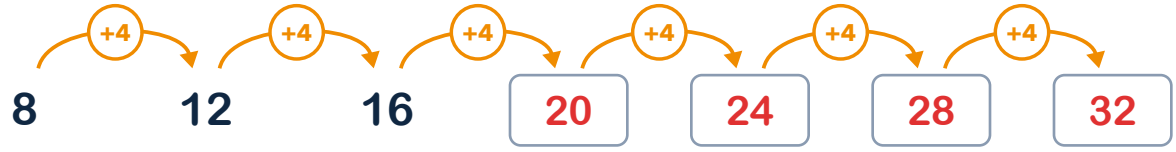
Part 1 Forward by 2s, 3s and 4s Fill in the next numbers.

1) 

2) 

3) 

4) 

5) 

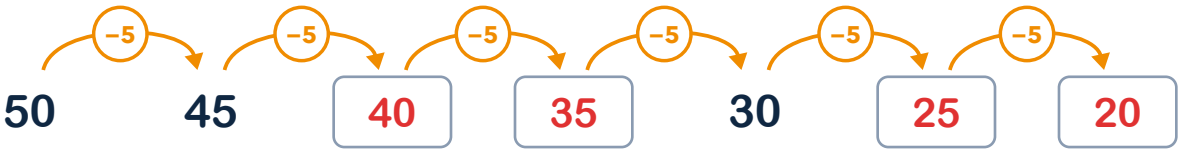
6) 

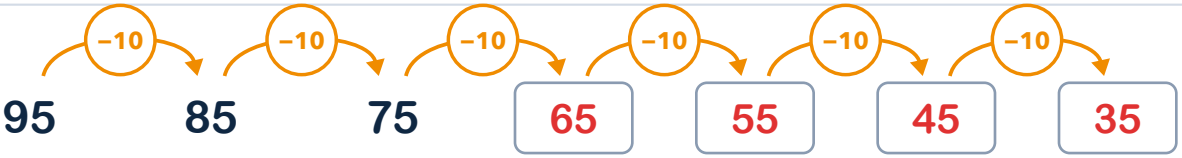
Part 2 Backward Jump back each time. The numbers get smaller.

7) 

Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 2 Backward (continued)

8) 

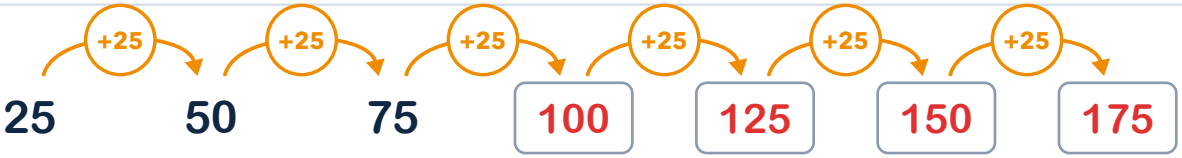
9) 

10) 

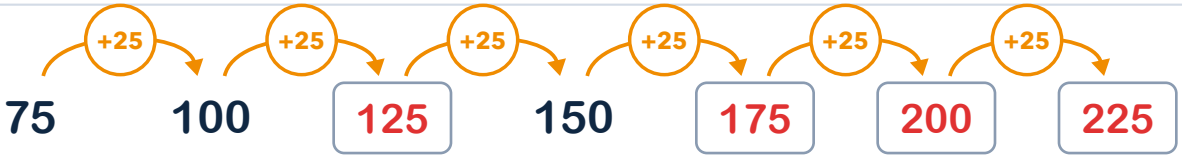
11) 

12) 

Part 3 By 25s 25, 50, 75, 100 … like counting quarters.

13) 

14) 

15) 

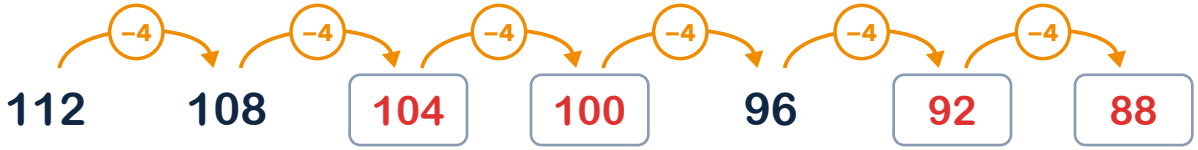
Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 3 By 25s (continued)

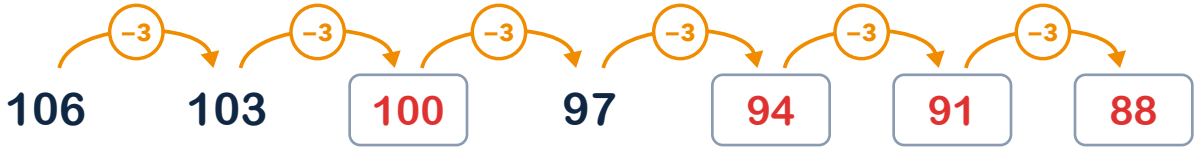
16) 

Part 4 Across a hundred Keep going past 100, or back below it.

17) 

18) 

19) 

20) 

Part 5 Forward or backward? Which way? By how much?

21) 3, 6, 9, 12 — Count **forward** by **3**

22) 40, 36, 32, 28 — Count **back** by **4**

23) 50, 45, 40, 35 — Count **back** by **5**

Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 5 Forward or backward? (continued)

24) 11, 13, 15, 17 — Count **forward** by **2**

25) 100, 75, 50, 25 — Count **back** by **25**

26) 22, 25, 28, 31 — Count **forward** by **3**

Part 6 Count forward No help this time.

27) 6, 9, **12**, 15, **18**

28) 14, **18**, 22, **26**, 30

29) 35, 40, **45**, **50**, 55

30) 9, 11, 13, **15**, **17**

31) 50, **75**, 100, 125, **150**

32) 17, 20, **23**, 26, **29**

33) 72, **76**, 80, **84**, 88

34) 110, 120, **130**, **140**, 150

Part 7 Count backward No help this time.

35) 20, 18, **16**, 14, **12**

36) 45, **40**, 35, **30**, 25

37) 33, 30, **27**, **24**, 21

38) 28, 24, 20, **16**, **12**

39) 100, **90**, 80, 70, **60**

40) 150, 125, **100**, 75, **50**

Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 7 Count backward (continued)

41) 61, 59, 57, 55, 53

42) 39, 36, 33, 30, 27

Part 8 Jumps in your head No help this time. Count the jumps.

43) $5 + 3 + 3 + 3 = 14$

44) $40 - 4 - 4 - 4 = 28$

45) $25 + 25 + 25 = 75$

46) $9 + 2 + 2 + 2 + 2 = 17$

47) $50 - 5 - 5 - 5 = 35$

48) $100 - 25 - 25 = 50$

49) $12 + 4 + 4 + 4 = 24$

50) $30 - 3 - 3 - 3 - 3 = 18$

Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 9 Word problems Count forward or backward.

51) A frog sits on step 2. It hops up 3 steps at a time. What step is it on after 4 hops?

Number sentence 2, 5, 8, 11, 14

Answer 14

Draw or show your work

52) A jar has 40 cookies. Each day 5 cookies are eaten. How many cookies are left after 3 days?

Number sentence 40, 35, 30, 25

Answer 25 cookies

Draw or show your work

53) You have 3 quarters. A quarter is 25 cents. How many cents do you have?

Number sentence 25, 50, 75

Answer 75 cents

Draw or show your work

54) Sam has 30 stickers. He gives 4 stickers to each of 3 friends. How many stickers does he have left?

Number sentence 30, 26, 22, 18

Answer 18 stickers

Draw or show your work

55) Challenge: Count back by 3s from 50. What is the first number you say that is less than 40?

Number sentence 50, 47, 44, 41, 38

Answer 38

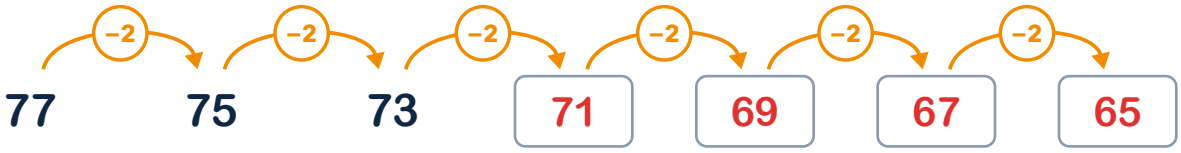
Draw or show your work

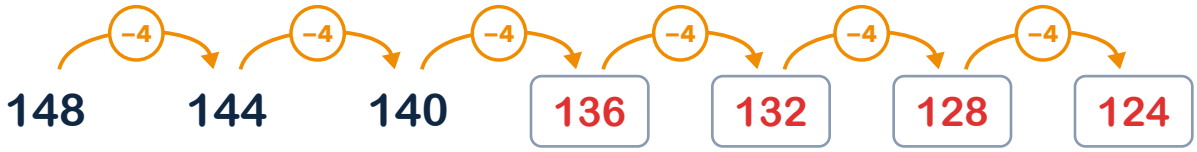
Check-In: Counting Forward and Backward

Show what you know. No help this time.

Mastery: 8 of 10 (80%)

Part 1 Keep counting

1) 

2) 

Part 2 Forward or backward?

3) 58, 83, 108, 133 Count **forward** by **25**

4) 51, 47, 43, 39 Count **back** by **4**

Part 3 Fill in the missing numbers

5) 131, **134**, 137, **140**, 143

6) 48, **44**, 40, **36**, 32

7) 35, **30**, 25, **20**, 15

8) 84, **109**, 134, **159**, 184

9) 71, **73**, 75, **77**, 79

10) 136, **140**, 144, **148**, 152